Luca Henkel

Email: henkel@ese.eur.nl | Website: https://luca-henkel.github.io/

Research Interests

Behavioral Economics, Household Finance

Employment

2024 –	**Assistant Professor of Finance**, Erasmus University Rotterdam
2023 – 24	Postdoctoral Scholar, University of Chicago and University of CEMA

Education

2016 – 23	Ph.D. in Economics *(summa cum laude)*, University of Bonn
2016 – 17	Visiting Ph.D. Student, University of California, Berkeley
2016 – 20	M.Sc. in Economics *(with distinction)*, University of Bonn
2013 – 16	B.Sc. in Economics *(with distinction)*, University of Bonn

Affiliations

Director	Joint Initiative for Latin American Experimental Economics (JILAEE)
Network Affiliate	CESifo Research Network
Research Affiliate	IZA@LISER - Institute of Labor Economics
Research Fellow	Tinbergen Institute
Associate Member	Erasmus Research Institute of Management (ERIM)
Senior Fellow	Microsoft AI Economy Institute

Short-term Research Visits

2026	Becker Friedman Institute for Economics, University of Chicago
2025	Department of Economics, University of Chicago
2025	FAIR Centre, Norwegian School of Economics

Publications

Proud to Not Own Stocks: How Identity Shapes Financial Decisions Paper
with Christian Zimpelmann
The Review of Financial Studies, *2026*

Experimental Evidence on the Relationship between Perceived Ambiguity and Likelihood Insensitivity Paper
Games and Economic Behavior, *2024*

Historical narratives about the COVID-19 pandemic are motivationally biased Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Robert Böhm, and Cornelia Betsch
Nature, *2023*

The association between vaccination status identification and societal polarization Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Lars Korn, Cornelia Betsch and Robert Böhm
Nature Human Behaviour, *2023*

Different interventions for COVID-19 primary and booster vaccination? Effects of psychological factors and health policies on vaccine uptake Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Robert Böhm and Cornelia Betsch
Medical Decision Making, *2023*

Payments and freedoms: Effects of monetary and legal incentives on COVID-19 vaccination intentions in Germany Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz and Cornelia Betsch
PLOS ONE, *2022*

Working Papers

Self-Image as Identity Paper
with Roland Bénabou
Handbook of the Economics of Identity, Forthcoming

The Role of Interpersonal Uncertainty in Prosocial Behavior Paper
with Anujit Chakraborty
American Economic Review, Reject and Resubmit

Ends versus Means: Kantians, Utilitarians, and Moral Decisions Paper
with Roland Bénabou and Armin Falk
The Economic Journal, Revise and Resubmit

Eliciting Moral Preferences under Image Concerns: Theory and Experiment Paper
with Roland Bénabou, Armin Falk and Jean Tirole
Games and Economic Behavior, Conditionally accepted

Limited Self-knowledge and Survey Response Behavior Paper
with Armin Falk, Thomas Neuber, and Philipp Strack

Cues, Attention, and Charitable Giving Paper
with Christoph Oslislo and Frederik Schwerter

Voice AI in Firms: A Natural Field Experiment on Automated Job Interviews Paper
with Brian Jabarian

Understanding and mitigating climate policy polarisation Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Cornelia Betsch, and Robert Böhm

Policy Writings

Identification, polarization, and their societal and political consequences Paper
with Robert Böhm, Philipp Sprengholz, and Cornelia Betsch
United Nations Human Development Report 2023-24, *2024*

Personal motivations polarize people's memories of the COVID-19 pandemic Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz
Nature, 2023

Learning from the past? How biased memories of the pandemic endanger preparation for future crises Paper
with Philipp Sprengholz, Robert Böhm, and Cornelia Betsch
Clinical and Translational Medicine, 2023

Wie die Pandemie zu Polarisierung und gesellschaftlicher Destabilisierung beiträgt
with Cornelia Betsch, Philipp Sprengholz, and Robert Böhm
Multiple Krisen der Gegenwart, 2025 [Link to book]

Teaching

2026	Seminar Behavioral Finance (Undergraduate, EUR, rating 4.2/5‡)
2025	Seminar Interest Rates and the Stock Market (Undergraduate, EUR, rating 4.5/5‡)
2025	Minor Behavioral Finance (Undergraduate, EUR, rating 4.3/5‡)
2024	Minor Behavioral Finance (Undergraduate, EUR, rating 4.1/5‡)
2022	Course Behavioral Economics (Undergraduate, UBonn, rating 1.5/5*)
2021 – 22	Research Module in Management and Applied Micro (Graduate, UBonn, unrated)
2020 – 21	Seminar Scientific Work Methods (Undergraduate, UBonn, rating 1.1/5*)

‡ *Erasmus University Rotterdam: 5 represents the best grade.*
* *University of Bonn: 1 represents the best grade.*

Conferences and Seminars

Conferences: ♦*Presenter;* ◊*Discussant;* **Participant*

2027	*Invited seminars:* University of Antwerp | Università Cattolica Milan *(scheduled)*
2026	*Invited seminars:* Paris School of Economics | University of Gothenburg | University of Glasgow | University of Tokyo | Utrecht University *Conferences:* Behavioral Approaches to Financial Decision-Making Conference◊ | Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference* | EFA Annual Meeting 2026◊ | ERINN Conference♦ | New Frontiers in Behavioral Research Workshop* | Recent Advances in Behavioral Economics Workshop♦ | Workshop on Cognitive Economics♦ | 5th Workshop on Field Experiments in Economics and Business♦ | 11th Maastricht Behavioral Economic Policy Symposium♦ *(includes scheduled)*

2025 *Invited seminars:* Erasmus School of Economics | University of Amsterdam | University of Chicago | University of Cologne | University of Konstanz | RWI Research Seminar
Conferences: AI at Work Retreat* | CESifo Area Conference on Behavioral Economics♦ | CESifo Workshop on the Economic and Societal Impacts of AI♦ | Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference* | 17th Maastricht Behavioral and Experimental Economics Symposium♦ | SFI-SCG Corporate Social Responsibility Workshop◊ | 2025 World Congress of the Econometric Society♦ | Zeuthen Workshop on Cognitive Foundations of Economic Decision-making♦

2024 *Invited seminars:* Berlin Behavioral Economics Seminar | UC Davis | Cornell University | London School of Economics | Middlebury College | ODISSEI | University of Chicago | University of Chicago Booth School of Business | Universidad Torcuato Di Tella | University of Zürich
Conferences: Bay Area Behavioral and Experimental Economics Workshop♦ | Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference♦ | Workshop on Beliefs, Narratives, and Memory♦

2023 *Invited seminars:* Bocconi University | Development Bank of Latin America and the Caribbean (CAF) | Carnegie Mellon University | Erasmus School of Economics | Goethe University Frankfurt | NYU Abu Dhabi | Rotterdam School of Management | University of CEMA | University of Essex | University of San Andrés
Conferences: Bonn-Frankfurt-Mannheim PhD Conference♦ | CESifo Area Conference on Behavioral Economics♦ | ERINN Conference♦ | LACEA Annual Meeting* | SAFE Household Finance Workshop♦ | SEHO Annual Meeting♦

2018 – 22 *Conferences:* briq Summer School in Behavioral Economics | Bonn-Mannheim PhD Conference♦ | 6th CRC TR 224 Conference♦ | 10th CRC TR 224 Conference♦ | EEA Annual Congress♦ | ESA Global Conference♦ | SEF Experimental Finance Conference♦ | VfS Annual Conference♦

Professional Service

Conference Organizer
Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference (ECBE): IZA, Bonn (2024); NHH, Bergen (2025); Booth School of Business, Chicago (2026); University of Zurich, Zurich (2027)
Chicago School in Experimental Economics (CSEE): University of Chicago (2024); University of Chicago (2025); IZA and University of Bonn (2025); University of Osaka (2026); University of CEMA (2026)
Erasmus Early-Career Finance Retreat (2026); Erasmus University Rotterdam
Workshop in Behavioral and Experimental Economics (2026); Universidad Di Tella
Bonn-Mannheim PhD Conference (2020); University of Bonn

Seminar Organizer
ERIM Field Experiments Seminar (2025 – present, Erasmus University Rotterdam)
Applied Micro Coffee Seminar (2019 – 2022, University of Bonn)

Refereeing	*Economics:* American Economic Review | Econometrica | Economic Journal | Economics Letters | European Economic Review | Experimental Economics | Games and Economic Behavior | Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization | Journal of Economic Psychology | Journal of Political Economy | Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics | Journal of Public Economics | Journal of the European Economic Association | Journal of Human Resources | Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics | Management Science | Review of Economics and Statistics *Other:* British Journal of Health Psychology | Humanities and Social Sciences Communications | Self and Identity *Conferences:* EFA Annual Meeting 2024, EFA Annual Meeting 2026, VfS Annual Conference 2026 *Grants:* UK Research and Innovation Research Grant
Hiring Committee	Erasmus University Rotterdam (AP) 23/24, 24/25 | JILAEE (Postdoc) 23/24, 24/25, 25/26 | University of Chicago (Postdoc) 24/25, 25/26
Other	Award Committee, Advances with Field Experiments Conference (2025); Member of the selection committee, German Academic Exchange Service (2019)

Grants

	Total: ≈ $520,000; As PI: **≈ $425,500**
PI	*Projects:* Schmidt Sciences AI at Work Research Grant ($200,000) | Schmidt Sciences Proposal Development Award ($10,000) | University of Chicago Research Grant ($23,875) | CRC TR 224 Research Grant (23,737€, multiple projects) | Selten Seeding Grant (15,800€, multiple projects) | ECONtribute Research Grant (4,820€) | IZA Research Grant (3,250€) | Young ECONtribute Program Grant (1,032€) *Conferences:* ECBE funding (77,440€, multiple sources) | CSEE funding (45,000€, multiple sources)
Co-PI	*Projects:* Microsoft AI Economy Institute Research Grant ($94,500)

Awards and Scholarships

2023	Finalist for the Distinguished CESifo Affiliate Award in Behavioral Economics
2017 – 20	Dissertation Scholarship, Bonn Graduate School of Economics
2016 – 17	Scholarship for Graduates, German Academic Exchange Service
2014 – 18	Merit Scholarship, Friedrich Ebert Foundation

Media Mentions

Ärztezeitung | Berliner Kurier | Bloomberg | Business Insider | Chicago Booth Review Podcast | Der Standard | El Espectador | FAZ | Financial Times | Focus | Fortune | Huff Post | Knowable Magazine | Kurier | Latest Thinking | Marginal Revolution | MDR | MedPage Today | NDR | ORF | Poets & Quant | Salzburger Nachrichten | Spiegel | Springer Professional | Süddeutsche | SWR | Sydney Morning Herald | Tagesschau | Tagesspiegel | TF1 | The Fast Company | The Information | Toronto Star | VOL | Wiener Zeitung | WirtschaftsWoche | Zeit

Miscellaneous

Citizenship German

Languages German (native), English (fluent), Spanish (beginner)

Last update: August 17, 2026